

From: Dean of Students deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie 
Subject: Re: Question regarding University of Galway suspension and complaints process
Date: 26 September 2024 at 10:54
To: Cian Mac Liatháin cmacliathain01@qub.ac.uk

Dear Cian,

Thank you for your email. I am very sorry to read about the assault, and I hope you're doing okay after it. I will follow up with ISS to determine how you can access your University of Galway account without your phone. Do you have access to a phone at all at the moment? If so, we should be able to set you up with access via that, but I'll check the specifics and come back to you.

I can assure you, I have responded to you. Due to the problems accessing your account, you are unlikely to have seen my reply to your earlier emails. I have both attached it to this email, and copied the content below. In line with the terms of your temporary suspension, please ensure when you email that you are using the Dean of Students email account only; Maeve, and other colleagues, should not be copied in.

All best wishes,
Ciara

Content of email sent to c.maclathain2@universityofgalway.ie, 25/09/2024

Dear Cian,

Thank you for taking time to set out your response to the notice about a temporary suspension and support, invoked under QA269. I have shared this also with the review panel that will meet you as part of the QA269 stage three process, so that they are aware of your feedback. There will also be further opportunities for you to comment, once the chair of the panel has been in contact with you. Full details about the stage 3 process can be found in appendix 4 of the attached document.

In the meantime, below are responses to some of your questions.

You were asked not to include other email addresses in your correspondence with this Office. I have removed Maeve McCaldin from my reply. I would ask you to adhere to this request in any future emails. Please note, the typical response time from my Office is three working days.

Please remember, Cian, this suspension is a temporary measure, taken with a view to the duty of care owed to both yourself and the University community. We want to work with you.

All best wishes,
Ciara

1. **Do I still have access to student service like free legal aid?** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
2. **Did I threaten anyone or claim to be aggressive or self-harming?** Details of concerns that caused the temporary suspension and support under QA269 to

be invoked have been recorded in a 'note of concern' that will be shared with you by the review panel as part of the stage 3 process. I have re-attached the policy, sent in my email of 20 September, for ease of access.

3. **Your concerns for my wellbeing are unwarranted. I am not in crisis, what gave you that impression?** As above.
4. **What serious grounds, can you elaborate to me were deemed serious or concerning? Did I clog your IMAP servers?** As above.
5. **I will retain full right to contact my Disability Advisor Maeve McCaldin, though?** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
6. **How is this review panel arranged, do any of them know me personally? You drew a false conclusion I believe.** Membership of the review panel is set out in Appendix 4, section 2 'Membership' (attached). Here is the relevant extract:

The Review Panel shall be constituted as follows:

- Chairperson, appointed by the President or Designated Authority
 - Academic Secretary, or nominee, as secretary to the panel
 - Three members, selected by the Registrar & Deputy President, from the panel nominated by the Academic Council
 - Two student representatives, normally members of the Student Union Executive.
7. **Am I free to access the Student Emergency Fund? I receive Disability Allowance for my perfectly self-managed anxiety / trauma / identity disorder.** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
 8. **Have plenty pdfs of references from those more expert than me in terms of psychological or educational claims of mine.** You will be invited to submit any relevant documentation to the review panel in advance of the meeting.
 9. **And how many representatives can I bring to this review panel? Maeve McCaldin, Kathy O'Sullivan and Cornelia Connolly please.** As per Appendix 4, section 4.3 of QA269 (attached): 'The student may be accompanied at the meeting by a Students' Union representative, a fellow student or family member or others as appropriate. Students with a disability may also be accompanied by a support worker where required'.
 10. **I am estranged from my adult family and distant from my grandmother and younger siblings, represent myself, I repeat am not at risk... what counter information and from whom are you claiming I deserve suspension?** As per Appendix 4, section 4.2 of QA269 (attached): 'The student will be invited in writing to attend and given at least 7 days' notice of the Review Meeting and informed of the purpose of the meeting. They will also be provided with copies of any documents, which will be considered in the meeting'

11. **If I wrote this email in my mother tongue of Gaeilge would you find that more misconstruingly offensive?** You are welcome to correspond with me as Gaeilge.
12. **You were quick to send me this suspension, what about a reply for the valid complaint I've already submitted to NUIG following your complaints process?** I have consulted with the Students' Union on your complaint as SULT is operated by the SU, not University of Galway. The SU has confirmed that security working at SULT are not University of Galway employees, which means that I am not in a position to progress the complaint in its current form. The SU, however, can investigate the complaint. With your complaint, I can officially forward your complaint to them.
13. **Let me make a list of all the above questions to simplify your reply, it is my right as a BME graduate to require you to reply to each one as that is what a teacher does, no?** Queries will be answered within a reasonable timeframe.
14. **I am estranged from my adult family and distant from my grandmother and younger siblings, represent myself, I repeat am not at risk... what counter information and from whom are you claiming I deserve suspension?** Answered above.
15. **If I wrote this email in my mother tongue of Gaeilge would you find that more misconstruingly offensive?** Answered above.
16. **You were quick to send me this suspension, what about a reply for the valid complaint I've already submitted to NUIG following your complaints process?** Answered above.
17. **What serious grounds, can you elaborate to me were deemed serious or concerning? Did I clog your IMAP servers?** Answered above.
18. **I will retain full right to contact my Disability Advisor Maeve McCaldin, though?** Answered above.
19. **I am a remote student, I live safe and sound in Belfast, your suspension and suggestion of myself from physically attending the campus is rather irrelevant and misinterpretation of my written text is not my prerogative – English is my second language. What makes you think your concerns are warranted?** Details of concerns that caused the temporary suspension and support under QA269 to be invoked have been recorded in a 'note of concern' that will be shared with you by the review panel as part of the stage 3 process.

Prof Ciara Meehan (she/her)

Déan na Mac Léinn | Dean of Students



Uimhir Carthanachta Cláraithe/Registered Charity Number 20002107

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <cmacliathain01@qub.ac.uk>
Sent: 26 September 2024 10:37
To: Dean of Students <deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>
Cc: McCaldin, Maeve <maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>; Meehan, Ciara <Ciara.Meehan@universityofgalway.ie>
Subject: Question regarding University of Galway suspension and complaints process

EXTERNAL EMAIL: This email originated outside the University of Galway. Do not open attachments or click on links unless you believe the content is safe.

RÍOMHPHOST SEACHTRACH: Níor tháinig an ríomhphost seo ó Ollscoil na Gaillimhe. Ná hoscail ceangaltáin agus ná cliceáil ar naisc mura gcreideann tú go bhfuil an t-ábhar sábháilte.

As previously discussed, I was told only to contact the Dean of Students email (and obviously I retain the right to contact my peers and previous lecturers as is my right as an alumnus – the suspension was with regard to my status as a postgraduate student, not a suspension of my memory nor rights as a citizen/alumnus) and have received no responses from this email.

As a victim of assault recently, I seem to be locked out of my University of Galway emails and am unsure if this is coincidental with the sudden and shocking suspension for the first time after a great tenure of 12 years at NUIG, shortly following my official complaint against NUIG Security – a complaint I received no update from but was quick to be suspended.

As previously iterated, I was a patient of a Professor Colm McDonald and was within my right to begin a Medical Council complaints process against him – my written word seems to have been misconstrued as a threat to your campus, which luckily due to the Freedom of Information act and IMAP server records I'll be able to refute.

You wouldn't blame a student for having CPTSD and sustaining a concussion, would you?

I'm safe and sound under the protection of the PSNI in Belfast, but without my phone, how can I access my email account and Canvas as is my right as a student of University of Galway?

